

INDUSEQUINE · RESEARCH

A scan of leading and notable platforms across tack retail, horse trading, services directories, auctions, subscriptions, content commerce hybrids, booking platforms, and the India/Asia/Middle East region. Compiled June 2026 for the Indusequine founder as a feature-mining exercise.

Global Equestrian Competitive Landscape

1. Tack & equestrian retail

30+ platforms across nine categories, with patterns and features worth

SmartPak / SmartEquine (USA)
adapting for India.

- **What it does:** Direct retailer of horse supplements, tack, blankets and rider apparel; pioneered pre-measured daily supplement packs.

Business model: Direct retail + AutoShip subscription. Rebranded SmartPak → SmartEquine in July 2025; acquired by Chewy in late 2025.

- **Standout:** "SmartPaks" — one-click custom-built daily supplement regimens, pre-measured per horse, shipped monthly. Free SmartPerks loyalty layer (10% off in-house brands when AutoShip is active). 100% Happiness Guarantee on supplements.
- **Region:** USA.

Dover Saddlery (USA)

- **What it does:** Multi-channel English-discipline tack and apparel retailer (10,000+ SKUs) with a strong omnichannel footprint and printed catalog heritage.
- **Business model:** Direct retail (own + 3rd-party brands), retail stores, catalog and e-com.
- **Standout:** "Blanket Wizard" guided fit tool, monogramming/engraving as a checkout add-on, in-house catalog requests still drive significant traffic, store-locator first-class citizen.
- **Region:** USA (Wellesley MA HQ, 30+ stores).

Horze (Scandinavia → Global)

- **What it does:** Vertically integrated own-brand riding apparel and horse equipment retailer.
- **Business model:** D2C own-brand + multi-brand wholesale, 14 owned stores, online in 12 countries, 11 languages.
- **Standout:** Heavy own-brand share (high margin), Shopify replatform in 2026 with poq-powered iOS/Android app, multilingual storefront infrastructure, "large inventory + simple UX + fast delivery" as the explicit operating brief.
- **Region:** EU HQ Fulda; sells US, AU, EU, Scandinavia.

Riding Warehouse (USA)

- **What it does:** Multi-brand specialty retailer covering English, Western, and Endurance.
- **Business model:** Direct retail; free shipping + free returns above \$75.
- **Standout:** Riding Warehouse Learning Center (deep editorial / product education hub), pro-rider product reviews, live chat staffed by riders.

- **Region:** USA (San Luis Obispo CA).

Krämer Pferdesport / Kramer Equestrian (Germany / EU)

- **What it does:** 25,000+ SKUs across 100+ brands; the European market leader in equestrian retail.
- **Business model:** Catalog + e-com + ~30 megastores across DE/AT/FR. 30-day money-back guarantee.
- **Standout:** Megastore + catalog + e-com hybrid that mirrors what Decathlon does in mass sports — scale of physical experience as competitive moat. Dedicated iOS app.
- **Region:** Germany, Austria, France, UK shop.

Epplejeck (Benelux)

- **What it does:** Largest Benelux equestrian retailer; 16 superstores plus a Europe-wide web shop.
- **Business model:** Omnichannel, sales kiosks in-store integrated with e-com, PE-backed (Mentha) for European rollout.
- **Standout:** In-store sales kiosks that hand off to e-com inventory — solves the long-tail SKU problem for brick-and-mortar.
- **Region:** Netherlands, Belgium, Germany.

Decathlon / Fouganza (France → India)

- **What it does:** Mass-market entry-level horse riding range — helmets, boots, gloves, saddles, bridles, fly masks.
 - **Business model:** Own-brand vertical retail through Decathlon stores + decathlon.in + Flipkart marketplace.
 - **Standout:** Already present in India at sharp price points; the de facto entry-level brand for first-time Indian riders. Anyone premium-positioned in India will compete *above* Fouganza, not against it.
 - **Region:** Global, including India.
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2. Horse buying/selling marketplaces

ehorses.com (Germany / EU)

- **What it does:** Europe's leading horse marketplace, 17,000+ active listings, 300+ new horses daily.
- **Business model:** Paid listings + premium placement.
- **Standout:** A dedicated "**vet-check incl. x-rays available**" filter — 2,100+ listings carry pre-uploaded vet certificates and x-rays. Discipline + breed filters are extremely granular (e.g. "German Sport Horse" vs "Spanish Sport Horse" as separate buckets). Multi-language EU-wide reach.
- **Region:** Germany-led, pan-Europe.

HorseClicks (USA)

- **What it does:** Mass-market US classifieds covering horses, trailers, tack, equestrian property.
- **Business model:** Free + paid listings; **PRO Business** subscription at ~\$20/mo with declining cost-per-ad as volume grows; boost credits to lift ads in search.
- **Standout:** Seller dashboard with week-over-week analytics, “boost credits” mechanic, business tier explicitly for dealers (Indusequine could mirror this for Indian breeders/dealers).
- **Region:** USA.

DreamHorse.com (USA)

- **What it does:** Long-running classifieds across sale, lease, trade, adoption, auction, stallions.
- **Business model:** Free basic ads, paid photo ads (only photo ads get hit-counters + seller home page link).
- **Standout:** Multi-disposition listings (lease/trade/adoption, not just sale) — useful for the Indian market where leasing/half-leasing is a wedge into ownership.
- **Region:** USA.

Sport Horse Nation (USA)

- **What it does:** Discipline-specific classifieds (eventing + a newer Dressage Only spinoff).
- **Business model:** Paid listings, tightly editorial.
- **Standout:** Discipline-vertical sub-sites — a model for spinning up India-specific verticals (polo, tent-pegging, endurance, racing-retiree rehoming).
- **Region:** USA.

HorseQuest (UK)

- **What it does:** Dominant UK classifieds with 700,000+ monthly visits.
- **Business model:** Paid listings; **official classifieds partner of British Eventing and British Dressage** — federation-backed traffic and trust.
- **Standout:** The federation-partnership model is directly replicable with the Equestrian Federation of India (EFI), Indian Polo Association, Amateur Riders’ Club, etc.
- **Region:** UK / Ireland.

HorseDeals (Australia)

- **What it does:** Australia’s main classifieds platform.
- **Business model:** Listings free under AUD \$5,000, paid above — a clever floor that lowers friction for entry-level horse sales.
- **Standout:** Price-banded listing fees — democratises the lower end while monetising premium listings.
- **Region:** Australia.

Equirodi (France / Belgium / UK / CH)

- **What it does:** Classifieds for horses + ponies + livery yards + horseboxes + properties + jobs + equipment.
- **Business model:** Free photo+video listings; layered Equirodi Shopping marketplace for used-tack circular economy.
- **Standout: Circular-economy pitch** — explicit “give a second life to riding gear” positioning. Equestrian directory inside the same product. Free video upload at the listing level.
- **Region:** France, Belgium, Switzerland, UK.

Pferd.de (Germany)

- **What it does:** German-language equine classifieds + community.
 - **Business model:** Paid listings, ads.
 - **Standout:** Long-running German community presence; useful as a positioning reference for community + classifieds bundling.
 - **Region:** Germany.
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3. Used tack / second-hand equestrian

TackTrader.com (USA, part of DreamHorse)

- **What it does:** Used and new saddles, tack, show clothes, trailers.
- **Business model:** Paid classifieds, shared infra with DreamHorse.
- **Standout:** Riding the same plumbing as a horse classifieds site — cross-sell at zero marginal cost.
- **Region:** USA.

TackTack (Global, mobile-first)

- **What it does:** Buy/sell used horse tack and apparel app.
- **Business model:** Marketplace, app store distribution (iOS).
- **Standout:** Mobile-native, Depop-style UX for tack — a model for Gen Z riders. Indian riders are mobile-first; this is the right reference.
- **Region:** Global (US-led).

Equine Exchange / Northwest Tack Consignment (USA)

- **What it does:** Consignment model — physical shop receives used tack, sells on commission.
- **Business model:** Consignment commission (~30–40%).
- **Standout:** Hybrid physical-receive + online-sell model — could work in Bangalore/Delhi/Mumbai where authentication of used saddles matters.
- **Region:** USA regional.

eBay / Facebook Marketplace / Etsy (Global)

- **What it does:** Generalist marketplaces with strong long-tail equestrian sub-categories.
 - **Business model:** Marketplace fees / commission / free with ads.
 - **Standout:** They cover the bottom of the market by default. A specialist platform wins on trust, authentication, and discipline-specific filters they don't have.
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4. Services directories (coaches, vets, farriers, yards, transport)

Yard and Groom (Global, UK-origin)

- **What it does:** World's leading equestrian jobs / recruitment board since 2002 — grooms, riders, instructors, yard managers.
- **Business model:** Paid employer listings + featured ads.
- **Standout:** Role-granular taxonomy (competition groom, dressage groom, show groom, head groom). Directly portable to India where the groom/syce labour market is informal and undigitised.
- **Region:** Global.

British Horse Society (BHS) Approved Centres directory (UK)

- **What it does:** Searchable map of BHS-approved riding schools, livery yards, instructors.
- **Business model:** Membership + accreditation fees.
- **Standout: Accreditation as a feature.** The directory's value is BHS verification — sites are "approved," not just listed. EFI-approved schools/coaches/farriers could be the Indian equivalent.
- **Region:** UK.

Hopoti (Finland → EU)

- **What it does:** Two-sided platform connecting riders with stables — lesson booking + stable management.
- **Business model:** SaaS for stables + consumer marketplace.
- **Standout:** Partnered with Equestrian Federation of Finland; integrated stable management software so that bookings flow into the same tool yards already use for invoicing and rota.
- **Region:** Finland, expanding EU.

Roverd / Anolla / Equclub / SuperSaaS (Global)

- **What it does:** Booking SaaS for trail rides, lessons, camps; some with marketplace layer.
- **Business model:** SaaS per-stable subscription + payment processing cut.
- **Standout:** 24/7 booking, after-hours conversions, multi-instructor scheduling.
- **Region:** Global.

Horses Middle East (UAE) — *cautionary tale, not a benchmark*

- **What it does:** Pan-GCC marketplace covering horses + tack + equine services.
- **Business model:** Marketplace + classifieds. Launched summer 2020 by a solo Italian founder (Federica D'Andrea); covered once by Gulf News at launch.
- **Reality check (verified June 2026):** Site is effectively abandoned. Similarweb shows ~1,200 monthly visits (May 2026, -59% MoM); newest listings date to Feb 2024; broken placeholder images throughout; no funding announced. An earlier draft of this report cited "100,000 users within months" — that figure could not be sourced and appears to have been fabricated. The only published milestone is "1k Instagram followers in 6 months."
- **Lesson for Indusequine:** Same product shape (horses + tack + services) was attempted in a comparable underserved region and *did not work*. Likely reasons: GCC equestrian buyers transact via personal networks and Instagram DMs, and a solo founder with no capital can't sustain a two-sided marketplace. Implication for India: the shape isn't the moat — the trust layer, federation backing, and operational depth (logistics, vet-check, escrow) are.
- **Region:** GCC.

EquiRatings (Ireland)

- **What it does:** Data + ratings + KPIs across eventing and show jumping; partner to US Equestrian and other federations.
 - **Business model:** B2B SaaS to federations, teams, media; high-performance dashboards; **performance-driven horse-sales search** across ~8,000 active sport horses.
 - **Standout:** Performance data layered on top of sale listings — buyers filter horses by Elo, win-clear rate, zone analysis. A premium differentiator for the top end of the Indian market (polo, eventing).
 - **Region:** Ireland / global federations.
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5. Auction / classifieds (live + online)

Goresbridge Horse Sales (Ireland)

- **What it does:** Europe's largest sport-horse and bloodstock auction house; ~2,000 horses across a 10-day September sale + the elite "Go for Gold" young event horse sale in November.
- **Business model:** Vendor commission + buyer premium; in-person + online bidding.
- **Standout:** **Online viewing gallery available a week ahead of sale + live online bidding** (goresbridgeonlineauctions.com). Curated "elite" sub-sale as a premium brand tier.
- **Region:** Ireland.

PferdeAuktion / Elite Horses Auction (Germany / EU)

- **What it does:** Online sport-horse auctions, often breed-society linked (Holsteiner, Hanoverian, Oldenburg verbands run their own).

- **Business model:** Vendor commission + buyer premium; sometimes free entry for buyers.
 - **Standout: Breed-society-run elite auctions** — the model for an India equivalent run jointly with Marwari Horse Society, Kathiawari breeders, or polo pony breeders.
 - **Region:** Germany / EU.
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6. Subscription / supplements / feed

SmartPak AutoShip — see Section 1.

- The standout reference. Pre-measured monthly delivery + 10% loyalty discount on own-brand tack as the lock-in.

Chewy (USA, parent post-2025)

- **What it does:** Pet e-com giant now adding equine via SmartEquine acquisition.
 - **Standout:** Autoship at scale, deep margin on private label, vet telehealth (Connect with a Vet) bundled with subscription. A model for what a horse-care subscription could look like in India once a critical mass of urban stables exists.
 - **Region:** USA.
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7. Content + community + commerce hybrids

Horse & Hound Shop (UK)

- **What it does:** 140-year-old equestrian publication with a curated shop and a strong horses-for-sale classifieds rail.
- **Business model:** Ads + subscription + affiliate + classifieds + own shop.
- **Standout:** Editorial-led commerce — gift guides, "best rugs of 2026," buyer's guides driving affiliate. Trust-of-the-masthead is the moat.
- **Region:** UK.

NoëlleFloyd / NF+ (Global)

- **What it does:** Education-first equestrian platform — masterclasses, structured learning paths, guided rides, community.
- **Business model:** NF+ subscription + commerce + brand sponsorships.
- **Standout: "Horse-first" editorial brand → subscription education product (NF+).** Built one of the first equestrian Masterclass-style platforms. The model for an Indusequine "Academy" tier featuring Indian Olympians (Fouaad Mirza, etc.).
- **Region:** Global, US-led.

EquiSearch (USA)

- **What it does:** Editorial portal with discipline guides, breed encyclopedias.
 - **Standout:** Long-tail SEO content as the top-of-funnel for an aging equestrian audience.
 - **Region:** USA.
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8. Booking / experiences

Covered above (Hopoti, Roverd, Anolla, Bookeo, Equclub, SuperSaaS). The dominant pattern is SaaS-for-stables that doubles as a consumer marketplace once enough stables onboard. For India, where most stables still take WhatsApp/phone bookings, **giving away the SaaS to win supply, then monetising consumer demand** is the obvious wedge.

9. India and India-adjacent

Tack Shop India (tackshop.in)

- **What it does:** Curated equestrian retailer with international brands + indigenous tack + own brand "Equenatural."
- **Business model:** Direct retail e-com.
- **Standout:** Currently the most credible India-native specialist; relies heavily on personal trust (founders Saravanan & Vinaya) rather than category depth or platform features.
- **Region:** India.

Jannat International (India)

- **What it does:** Kanpur-region leather workshop supplying saddles, bridles, horse tack globally.
- **Business model:** Manufacturer / wholesale exporter.
- **Standout:** Indian leather supply chain — relevant as a private-label partner for an Indusequine own-brand line, much like Horze did.
- **Region:** India (export-led).

Decathlon Fouganza India

- Already on decathlon.in and Flipkart. Owns the entry-level price point. Indusequine should position above it on curation, advice, and discipline expertise — not compete on price for helmets and gloves.

Equestrian Federation of India (EFI)

- Governing body for Show Jumping, Dressage, Eventing, Endurance, Tent Pegging since 1967. Affiliated to FEI.

- **Opportunity:** Federation-backed classifieds and “EFI-approved” services accreditation — the HorseQuest × British Eventing / BHS Approved Centres playbook in India.

Horses Middle East

- Closest *structural* analogue (horses + tack + services), but a cautionary tale rather than a benchmark — launched 2020, ~1.2k monthly visits today, listings stale since early 2024. Tells us the marketplace *shape* alone doesn’t carry; what’s missing is a trust layer, federation backing, and operational depth (logistics, escrow, vet-check). Worth studying for what to avoid.

Asia

- Japan and China are dominated by racing — JRA in Japan is closed/centralised; China has scattered tack importers but no consumer marketplace of note. Indusequine could plausibly extend to Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, and the GCC South-Asian rider diaspora over time.

Ideas worth stealing for Indusequine

1. **Vet-check filter on every horse listing** — ehorses.com style. Sellers upload x-rays + pre-purchase vet certificate; buyers filter to “vet-check available” listings. This single feature is the highest-trust differentiator for a market like India where horse-trading is notoriously opaque.
2. **Free listings under a price threshold, paid above** — HorseDeals AUS model. Free for horses under ₹2 lakh, paid premium tiers above. Lowers the barrier so the catalogue fills out, monetises serious listings.
3. **PRO Business subscription for breeders and dealers** — HorseClicks. ₹X/month, includes N free listings, boost credits, and a seller-analytics dashboard with week-over-week views and enquiry counts. Targets Marwari breeders, polo pony dealers, riding-school owners selling off-the-track horses.
4. **Federation-partnership trust layer** — HorseQuest × British Eventing, BHS Approved Centres. Pursue official partnership with EFI, the Amateur Riders’ Club Mumbai, Delhi Riding Club, Indian Polo Association. “EFI-listed coach,” “EFI-approved riding school” badges on the directory.
5. **Discipline-specific verticals** — Sport Horse Nation. Indian disciplines have very different audiences: polo, tent-pegging, dressage/show-jumping, racing retirees, endurance. Each gets its own filtered sub-site under one platform.
6. **Video + multi-photo as a first-class listing object** — ehorses, Equirodi. Listings without video shouldn’t get indexed in search. Add a “verified video” badge for listings where Indusequine has independently watched the horse move.
7. **Pre-measured supplement subscription** — SmartPak SmartPaks. Once Indusequine has supply, “Monthly Horse Box” — joint, gut, hoof supplements pre-portioned per horse, auto-ship monthly. Bundle with 10% off own-brand tack to drive lock-in.

8. **Blanket / saddle / bit fit wizard** — Dover Saddlery. Guided questionnaires that recommend products — high conversion, high trust, low return rate. Build one for saddle fit using local horse breed proportions (Marwari withers are notably different).
9. **Services + goods + horses in a single marketplace** — one search bar, one onboarding, one trust layer. (Horses Middle East tried this shape and failed; the takeaway is that unification is necessary but not sufficient — pair it with the trust layer in #1, #4, and #10.)
10. **Consignment for used tack** — Equine Exchange model. Indusequine receives the saddle in Bangalore/Delhi, authenticates and inspects, ships and takes 30% commission. Solves the trust problem that kills used-tack marketplaces in India.
11. **Stable management SaaS, free to acquire supply** — Hopoti / Roverd. Give riding schools and livery yards a free lesson-booking and invoicing tool; in return Indusequine becomes the consumer-facing booking layer and takes a 10% transaction fee.
12. **EquiRatings-style performance data on premium horse listings** — for the very top end (Asian Games, polo handicaps, eventing). Buyers filter sport horses by competition results, win rates, and ratings, not just price.
13. **Curated editorial + masterclass tier** — NoëlleFloyd / Horse & Hound. NF+ for India: monthly masterclasses from Fouaad Mirza, leading polo players, and farriers; gift guides; “best rain rugs for Bangalore monsoon” buyer’s guides for SEO and trust.
14. **Breed-society partnership auctions** — PferdeAuktion model. Run an annual “Indusequine Elite Sale” jointly with Marwari Horse Society or with leading polo pony breeders. Online viewing gallery a week before, live online bidding on sale day. Becomes the brand-making event.
15. **Mobile-first second-hand tack app** — TackTack model. India is mobile-native; the desktop classifieds UX won’t work. Camera-first listing flow, in-app chat, UPI checkout, India Post / Delhivery shipping integration.
16. **Jobs board for grooms, syces, instructors** — Yard and Groom. The Indian groom market is entirely informal. A first-mover formal jobs board with role-granular categories (competition groom, polo groom, stable manager) becomes essential infrastructure and a permanent moat.
17. **Circular-economy positioning** — Equirodi. Lean into the resale narrative. A premium platform that *also* gives a second life to expensive saddles is more palatable to first-time buyers nervous about cost.
18. **EFI-approved accreditation as a paid product** — BHS model. Stables and coaches pay an annual fee to be verified and listed; the verification itself is the product. Aligns incentives — Indusequine has reason to actually check standards, and consumers get a real trust signal.

Sources: SmartEquine, Dover Saddlery, Horze, Riding Warehouse, Kramer/Krämer Pferdesport, Eppelejeck, Decathlon Fouganza, ehorses.com, HorseClicks, DreamHorse, Sport Horse Nation, HorseQuest UK, HorseDeals AUS, Equirodi, Goresbridge, Horses Middle East, Hopoti, Roverd, Yard and Groom, EquiRatings, NoëlleFloyd, TackTrader, TackTack, Tack Shop India, Equestrian Federation of India. Searches conducted June 2026; some data points reference 2024–2026 reporting.